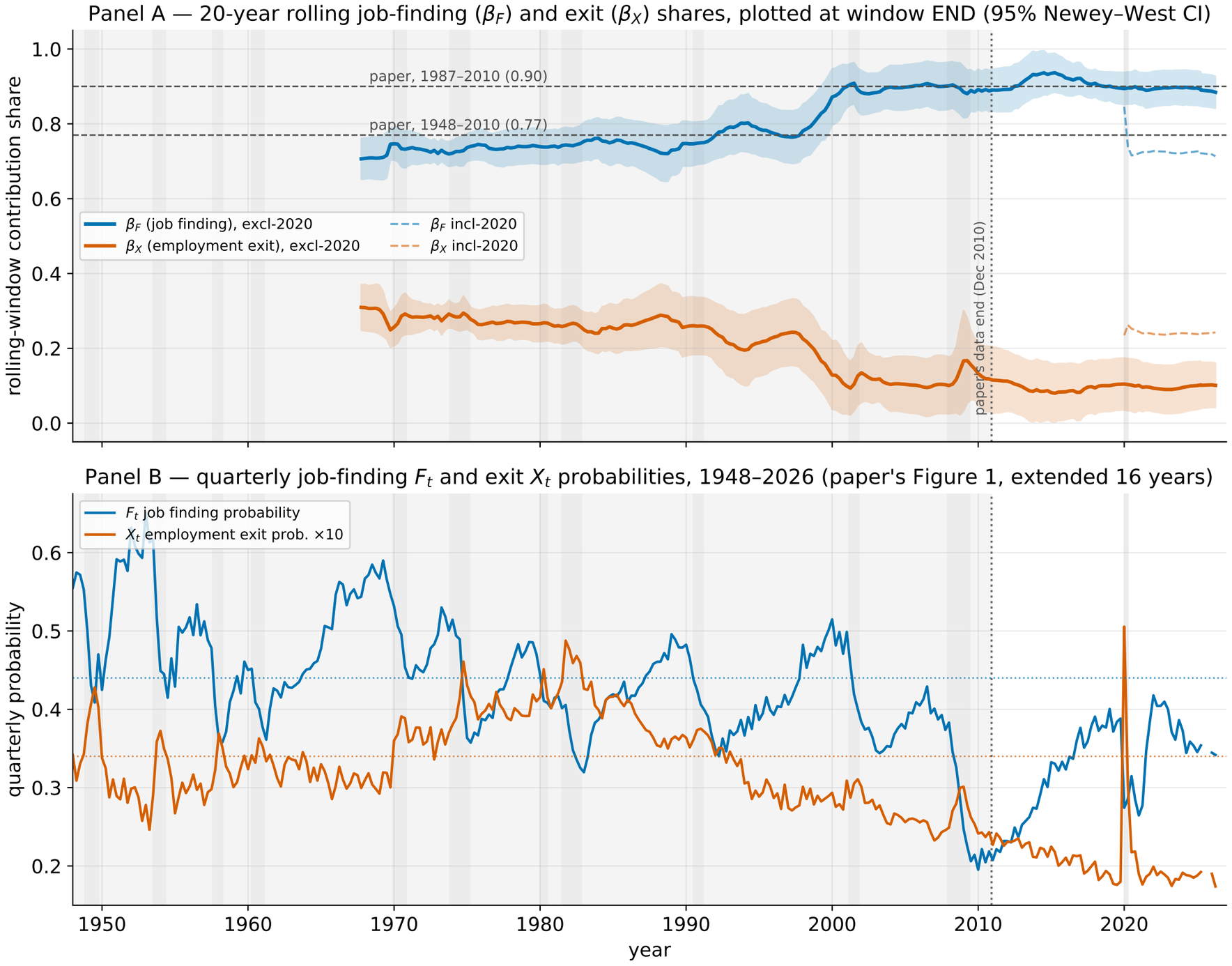
Reassessing the Ins and Outs of Unemployment (Shimer 2012), updated through 2026:
job finding still explains ~90% of unemployment-rate fluctuations — except the 2020 COVID layoff shock, where separations won



Source: CPS via FRED (UNEMPLOY, UEMPLT5, CE16OV, LNS17xxx flows); Shimer (2012) methodology; CPS-redesign factor 1.1 applied to short-term unemployment from 1994-01. Grey band = paper's original 1948–2010 sample; vertical bars = NBER recessions.